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CareCompass (CARE Bot) Product Guide

What is CareCompass?

CareCompass (CARE Bot) is a trauma-informed chatbot designed to support sexual assault survivors. It uses Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) to provide compassionate, evidence-based responses grounded in SAMHSA's six trauma-informed care principles: Safety, Trustworthiness, Peer Support, Collaboration, Empowerment, and Cultural Awareness.

The bot can assist survivors with:

- Mental Health Support
- Practical & Social Needs
- Legal & Advocacy Help
- Medical Follow-Up
- Delayed Follow-Up

CareCompass includes built-in crisis detection that identifies when a user may be in immediate danger and surfaces emergency resources (988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, Crisis Text Line).

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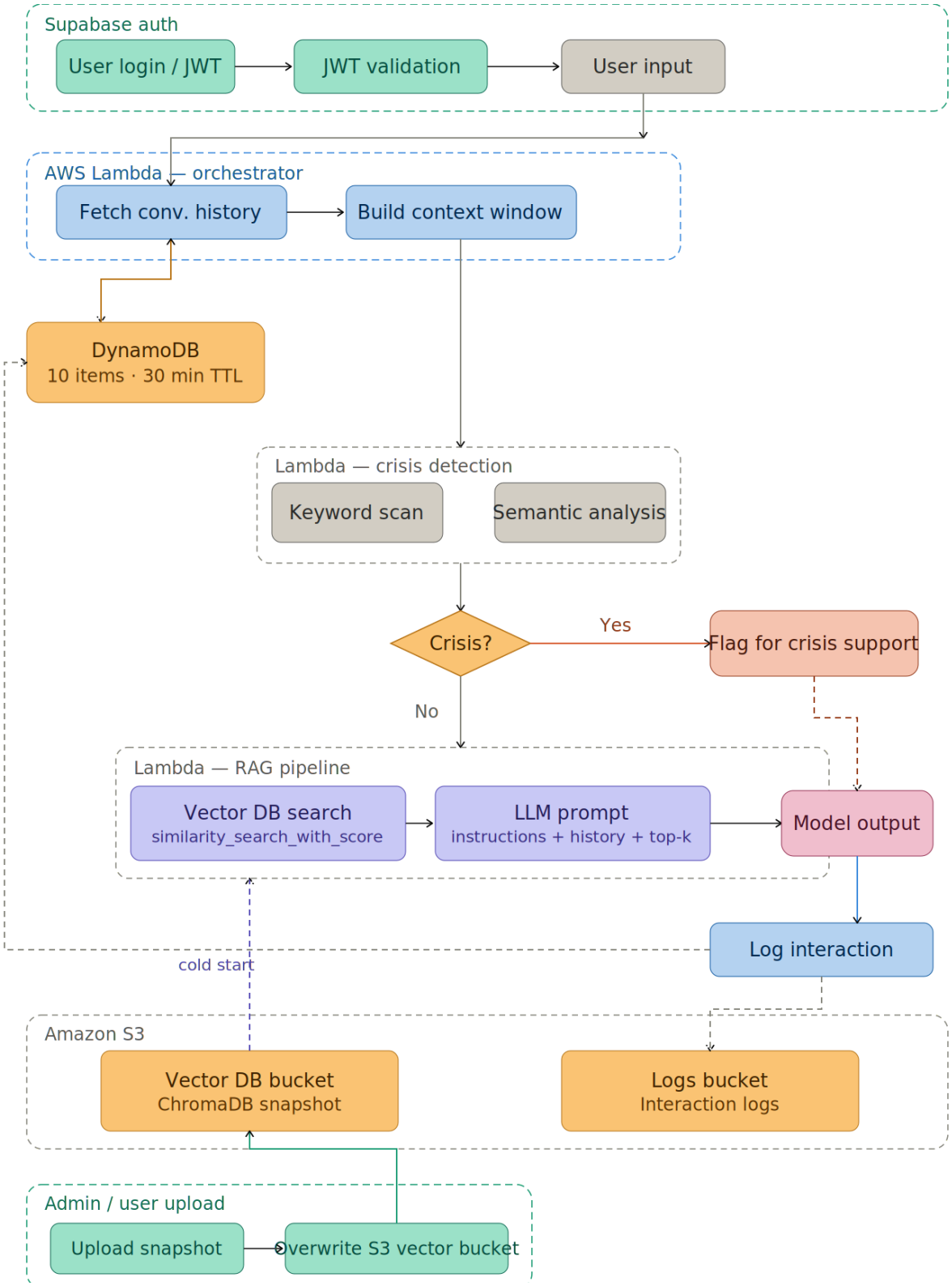
System Architecture



Application Features

Authentication

Users can access CareCompass in three ways:

- Sign in with email: Existing users authenticate via Supabase (email + password)
- Create an account: New users sign up with email verification
- Continue as a guest (no account required): a temporary session ID (guest-<uuid>) is generated. Guest sessions expire after 30 minutes

Chat Interface

- Welcome message: "Hello, you're safe here. I'm here to listen and provide support."
- Guided scenario buttons with three quick-start options:
    - Mental Health Support
    - Practical Needs Help
    - Legal & Advocacy Help
- Markdown-rendered responses: Bot responses support formatted text
- Conversation history: The bot remembers context within a session (up to 10 turns)
- Loading indicator: Animated "Thinking..." with bouncing dots while the bot processes

Crisis Detection

When the bot detects a user may be in crisis (via keywords or LLM assessment), the response prioritizes immediate safety resources:

- 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (call or text 988)
- Crisis Text Line (text HOME to 741741)

Crisis detection uses a two-layer approach: fast keyword matching before retrieval, plus LLM-based assessment of implicit signals like hopelessness or desperation.

Quick Exit

A safety feature for users who need to leave the application immediately:

- Quick Exit button: Always visible in the top bar; instantly redirects to Google.com
- ESC key shortcut: Press Escape at any time to trigger quick exit
- Designed for situations where a user needs to quickly hide the application

Resources Section

Scrolling below the chat reveals a local resources directory with contact information:

- Phone numbers are clickable (opens phone dialer)
- Website links open in a new tab
- National Domestic Violence Hotline highlighted as available in 200+ languages

Sign Out

Authenticated users can sign out via the button in the top bar (next to Quick Exit). Guest users do not see a sign-out button — their session simply expires.

Types of Questions You Can Ask

CareCompass answers questions based on its ingested knowledge base of trusted documents. Below are example questions organized by category, along with the source documents that back each topic.

Medical Follow-Up & Forensic Exam

Backed by: SAFE Protocol document, CDC HIV/Partner Services brochure

- "What happens during a forensic exam?"
- "What is the SAFE protocol?"
- "When should I get tested for STIs after an assault?"
- "What is HIV prophylaxis and how does it work?"
- "What are the timelines for HIV and STI testing?"
- "Do I need to go back for follow-up appointments?"
- "What is partner services and how does it work?"

Legal & Advocacy

Backed by: Marsy's Law victim rights card, Survivors' Right to Time Off FAQs, Sacramento Sheriff SA pamphlet

- "What are my rights as a survivor?"
- "What is Marsy's Law and how does it protect me?"
- "Can I take time off work because of what happened?"
- "How much time off am I entitled to?"
- "Do I have to report to the police?"
- "How do I get a protection order?"
- "What are my options if I'm not ready to report?"

Practical & Social Needs

Backed by: Sacramento Sheriff SA pamphlet, Survivors' Right to Time Off FAQs

- "What local resources are available in Sacramento?"
- "Where can I find a support group?"
- "What employment rights do I have as a survivor?"
- "How do I access victim compensation?"

Mental Health & Emotional Support

Backed by: SAMHSA Trauma-Informed Care framework

- "I'm having trouble sleeping since it happened"
- "I keep having flashbacks, is that normal?"
- "I feel anxious all the time and don't know what to do"
- "What does trauma-informed care mean?"
- "What are some coping strategies?"

General Support

- "I don't know where to start"
- "I just need someone to talk to"
- "What kind of help is available to me?"

If the bot detects a crisis, it will prioritize connecting you with emergency resources like the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline and Crisis Text Line (text HOME to 741741).